

Aristida chaseae

No common name – a grass

Family (Poaceae)

Kingdom (Plantae)

Status (Endangered)

Description

A perennial grass with densely tufted, wide-spreading culms that can reach 50–60 cm in length. It has involute leaf blades about 2–3 mm wide and 10–15 mm long. The panicles are narrow, and the glumes are equal, acuminate, and 10–13 mm long. The lemma is about 12 mm long, scabrous on the upper half, with a short, densely pilose callus, and produces three equal, slightly divergent awns about 2 cm long.



Location/Habitat

Found in southwestern Puerto Rico within the subtropical dry forest zone, particularly in the Cabo Rojo National Wildlife Refuge and the Sierra Bermeja. It occurs in grasslands and open areas with well-drained to excessively drained sandy or rocky soils, often in dry, fire-prone environments with low annual rainfall.